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SUPERSEDING
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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CASE, DISPATCH, ARTIFICIAL LEATHER

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for box type, drum style dispatch cases.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type, grade, sizes, and color. The dispatch cases covered by this specification shall be of one type and grade and of the following sizes (see 3.3) and color (see 1.2.2 and 3.4.3) and as specified (see 6.1 and 6.3):

Size 1 - 4 inch case
Size 2 - 3 inch case

1.2.2 The color of the dispatch cases shall be suntan (see 3.4.3).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.
Fed. Std. No. 601 - Rubber: Sampling and Testing.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

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Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Method:

T 411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park Atlanta, GA 30341.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) before production is commenced, a sample of the dispatch cases to be supplied shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Design. The finished dispatch case shall be box type, drum style.

3.3 Sizes. The finished outside dimensions of the cases shall be as follows:

Size 1 17-7/8± 1/2 X 12-5/16± 9/16 X 4± 1/4 inches.
Size 2 17-7/8± 1/2 X 12-5/16± 9/16 X 3± 1/4 inches.

The bottom section of the Size 1 Case shall be 2-1/2 ± 3/8 inches deep and the lid section 1-7/16 ± 5/16 inches deep. The bottom section of the size 2 case shall be 1-5/8 ± 5/16 inches deep and the lid section 1-3/8 ± 5/16 inches deep.

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3.4 Construction. The lid and bottom sections forming the case shall be constructed using one of the following methods.

3.4.1 Woodframe. The lid and bottom frame sections forming the case shall have a dovetailed or lock cornered construction. They shall be made of smoothly finished basswood, kiln dried ponderosa pine, plywood, or hardwood flakeboard. The basswood, pine or plywood shall be not less than 1/4 inch thick. The hardwood flakeboard shall be not less than 5/16 inch thick.

3.4.1.1 Lid and bottom sections. The material for the lid and bottom sections of the case shall be plain chipboard not less than 0.100 inch in thickness with all edges beveled and securely bonded to the wood frame.

3.4.1.2 Cushioning. The material for cushioning shall be a sheet of embossed cellulose material. It shall measure approximately 14 inches in length by 8 inches in width and shall be not less than 0.020 inch thick and weight 0.5 ± 0.1 ounces. It shall be placed between the top finishing panel and the chipboard forming the lid section.

3.4.1.3 Panels. There shall be two chipboard panels for the case. One each for the lid and bottom sections of the case. The chipboard panels shall be approximately 5/8 inch ± 1/8 inch less than the required length and width of the case (see 3.3). The chipboard panels shall be not less than 0.025 inch thick. They shall be covered with the exterior covering material of the case (see 3.4.3), securely glued and free from wrinkles, and bubbles. The adhesive used in bonding the covering material to the chipboard shall be a flexible synthetic adhesive or a flexible animal glue. No migratory adhesives nor hard or crystallizing type animal glue shall be used. In addition the covering material on each panel shall be stitched on all sides by a lock or chain stitch through the chipboard panel and through the lid or bottom, 3.4.1.1, by using not less than 3 stitches per inch, 1/8 to 1/4 gauge, of not less than 4 cord matching cotton sewing thread approximately 0.020 inch in diameter.

3.4.1.4 Interior supports. The case shall have interior lid and bottom supports of chipboard not less than 0.025 inch in thickness. The interior lid and bottom supports shall be covered with lining, (see 3.4.6), securely glued and free of wrinkles and bubbles. The adhesive used shall be as specified in 3.4.1.3. The interior supports shall cover the entire areas of lid and bottom. The lid support lining shall also be stitched on 3 sides to the chipboard by using not less than 4 stitches per inch, 1/8 to 1/4 gauge, of not less than 4 cord matching cotton sewing thread approximately 0.010 inch in diameter. In addition a file pocket shall be constructed of a suitable lining material (see 3.4.6), with a compartment not less than 2 inches wide. The file pocket shall be superimposed in the lid support and attached simultaneously by the same stitching as specified above for the lid support lining. The free edge of the file pocket shall be finished with 1/4 to 1/2 inch plastic binding of the same color (good commerical match) as the case. The binding shall be attached by a lock or chain stitch through the pocket material with the thread specified above. The file pocket shall have a retaining strap (s) or a catch or be otherwise designed so as not to fall open when the lid is closed.

3.4.2 Chipboard shell. The lid and bottom shells shall be constructed of solid molded chipboard not less than 0.200 inches thick after compression.

3.4.2.1 File pocket. A file pocket shall be constructed in the lid of the chipboard shell case. This file pocket shall be similar in construction to the file pocket described in 3.4.1.4.

3.4.3 Exterior covering material. The case shall have an exterior finishing cover of one of the following:

Polyvinyl-chloride film laminated to a cellulose fiber backing material.

The total weight shall be not less than 7 ounces per lineal yard, based on a 54-55 inch width.

3 gauge vinyl, laminated to a 5 gauge cellulose fiber backing.

A natural or synthetic rubber impregnated paper product coated with a synthetic resin compound weighing not less than 8.4 ounces per yard, based on a 50 inch width.

A synthetic resin coated cotton cloth, not less than 55 yarns per inch in the warp and not less than 45 yarns per inch in the filling and it shall weight not less than 5 ounces per yard based on a 42 inch width.

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A themo-plastic vinyl sheet not less than 0.012 inch thick and with at least a minus 10 degrees F. crackproof factor.

The exterior cover shall have an English saddle cowhide leather antique finish of suntan color conforming approximately to number 20100 of Federal Standard Number 595.

3.4.4 Handle. The handle for the case shall be solid plastic and can be of either of the following designs for both size cases.

Oval shaped, measuring 5-1/2 + 1/8 inches long overall and 2-1/2 + 1/8 inches in circumference when measured at the middle of the handle, with a clinched post type construction.

Flat shaped, which will lie relatively flat on the case when not in use; with slight curvature and contour or grip construction for secure grouping; the overall length of this handle shall be 5-3/4 + 3/8 inches, with a minimum girth of 2-1/4 inches when measured at the middle; thickness of the solid portions of this handle shall be not less than 7/64 inch. The handle shall have a ring and plate fastener assembly.

3.4.5 Hardware. The hardware shall be brass plated metal. The hardware shall consist of 4 feet or bumpers for elevating the case from the ground; 2 riveted exterior hinges, at the option of the manufacturer, the feet or bumbers may be an intergral part of the exterior hinges; 2 riveted locks; 2 riveted hasps for engagement of the locks; not less than 1 interior stay type lid hinge, to hole the lid in the open position and handle posts, or ring and plate fastener assemblies, depending upon the handle style. Edge guards attached at the four exterior corners of the lid and bottom sections are acceptable. Two keys in a paper envelope, shall be placed in each case, at the option of the manufacturer, the keys may be suitably fastened to the case handle.

3.4.6 Interior lining. The interior lining shall be any of the exterior covering materials or a pyroxolin or polyethylene coated embossed paper laminated to chipboard. The interior lining shall completely cover the entire interior and shall be a color or print that harmonizes with the exterior.

3.5 Marking for identification: The bottom of each case shall be permanently marked with the contractor's name or trademark, the Federal Stock Number and PROPERTY U. S. GOVERNMENT, in letters a minimum of 1/8 inch in height.

3.6 Workmanship. The workmanship shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrences of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels (AQL's).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When required, examination and testing of the preproduction sample for conformance to all the provisions of this specification shall be made of the dispatch case.

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4.3 Inspection for acceptance. Except when otherwise specified, inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1 Visual examination of the end item. Any defects found during visual examination shall be classified in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table I. All completed units of one size presented at one time for dlivery to the Government shall be considered a lot for the purpose of visual examination. The unit of product for this examination shall be one completed dispatch case. For sampling, cases shall be taken at random from each inspection lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level for each sample unit shall be inspection level II and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be 2.5. No destructive testing shall be conducted on samples for visual examination.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Color of Case Exterior	Color does not compare favorably with approved sample or color not uniform, seriously affecting appearance.
Finish	Exterior finish of case not as specified.
Cleanness	Any type stain or spot clearly noticeable.
Lining Material	Any hole, cut or tear.
Type and Style	Not box type or drum style.
Material: General	Any component not fabricated of the specified material.
Quality of exterior covering material and finish	Exterior covering material not finished as specified. Any hole, cut, rip, or puncture. Open or badly healed scratches having a serious affect on serviceability or appearance. Bubbles or wrinkles affecting serviceability or appearance.
Construction and Workmanship: General	Any component part or required operation omitted (unless otherwise specified herein). Any part broken, ripped, torn, punctured, malformed, or otherwise damaged seriously affecting serviceability. Any component misplaced or assembly malformed seriously affecting serviceability, e.g., lock clasp on lid not in proper alignment with lock on body of case causing serious malformation of the case when lock and clasp are joined.
Metal Components	Rivets not securely set or clinched to a degree where the component may become detached in service. Lock catches do not function properly. Lock does not function properly or keys missing or will not operate lock.
Seams and Stitchings	Not specified stitch type. Loose stitch tension resulting in loosely secured seam. Tight stitch tension causing rupture of material. One stitch less than minimum specified. Any row of stitching omitted Thread ends not trimmed. Open seam. NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped stitches or runoffs occur.
Marking	Omitted; incomplete; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

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4.4 Examination and testing of components and materials. The supplier is responsible for insuring that all components and materials used in fabricating dispatch cases were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification, or referenced subsidiary specifications. Component testing referenced in Table II, shall be performed on materials received at one time, of the same type and color, manufactured at the same source and essentially under the same conditions, and identified as used in the production of the quantity of the end items. The supplier shall maintain records or components and material testing. These records shall be available to the authorized Government representative, and shall include the source, date of receipt, component material designation, date of test(s), test data, and quantity of material represent-ated by the test report. Each component test report must be within the period of the period of the contract, or within the time authorized in the contract for production of standby stock in advance of the ordering period. Unless otherwise specified, the sample size shall be the sample unit specified in the applicable test method, selected at random with the shipment.

TABLE II Test Methods

Characteristic	Paragraph Reference	Method
Weight of cushioning material	3.4.1.2	Ounce scale
Weight of covering material and lining	3.4.3 & 3.4.6	5041 Fed. Std. No. 191
Yarns per inch	3.4.3	5050 -do-
Thickness of chipboard	3.4.1.1; 3.4.1.3; 3.4.1.4 and 3.4.2	T411 - Thickness of Paper and Paperboard
Ply (cord) of sewing thread	3.4.1.3	4054 Fed. Std. No. 191
Identification of cottom	3.4.3	1200 -do-
Identification of rubber	3.4.3	15011 of Fed. Std. No. 601

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking requirements comply with section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For examination of contents the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate sealing. Bulging or distortion of container.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Each case shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2.

5.1.2 Level B. Each case shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or to PPP-B-676. Each box shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto.

5.1.3 Level C. The cases shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Cases of one size and color, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3c. Each box shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape, and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six size 1 cases of one color, or eight size 2 cases of one color shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, grade 200.

5.2.3 Level C. The cases shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2.4 Standard pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in paragraphs 5.1.2 and 5.2.2 (see 6.2).

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size of case (see 1.2.1).
(c) If preproduction sample required (see 3.1).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing.

6.2 Standard pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.2.4 are intended for use in procurements of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue or shipment to eventual user.

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, etc. of the commodities indicated by the titles of specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable to Federal Government requirements.

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